

Keyword Research

Finding what your audience searches for and choosing the right targets

Start with seed keywords

- Ask sales and support staff what customers literally type or say.
- Read competitor menus and category pages.
- Use Google autocomplete and the People Also Ask box.

Reading intent from the results

- Type: what kind of page ranks?
- Format: list, how-to, review, comparison?
- Angle: what unique hook do top results share?

Keyword mapping

- One primary topic per page.
- Merge pages that target the same intent.
- Use Search Console to spot pages competing for the same query.

Metrics that matter

- Volume: how many people search.
- Difficulty: how much authority the current results have.
- Traffic potential: total traffic of the top result for the whole topic.
- Business value: how close the searcher is to becoming a customer.

Long-tail keywords

- Lower competition, clearer intent.
- Great for new sites with few backlinks.
- Often reveal real customer problems to write about.

Keyword research tools

Tool	Cost	Best for
Google Search Console	Free	Queries you already appear for, with real clicks and impressions
Google Keyword Planner	Free with Ads account	Volume ranges and related ideas
Google autocomplete / People Also Ask	Free	Real phrasing and question ideas
Ahrefs / Semrush	Paid	Difficulty, traffic potential, competitor keywords

Example keyword map (Kampala web studio)

Keyword	Intent	Target page
website design Kampala	Commercial / local	/services/web-design
how much does a website cost in Uganda	Informational	/blog/website-cost-uganda
ecommerce website with mobile money	Commercial	/services/ecommerce
WordPress vs Shopify for small business	Commercial investigation	/blog/wordpress-vs-shopify

Remember

- Choose keywords by intent and business value, not by volume alone.
- The live SERP is the best guide to what content will rank.
- Map one primary topic to one page to avoid cannibalisation.

Watch: Keyword Research Pt. 2: How to Find Keywords for Your Website — Ahrefs (SEO Course, lesson 1.3) — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G5W5GeDXNkU>